```
if ($a!==$b) {

echo "a and b are not equal<br/>";

}

?>
```

Output

7 is the greatest number
Either a or b is equal to 5
a and b are not equal

2.2.8 Concatenating Operator

Concatenating operator (.) allows you to combine two strings into one. It appends the second string to the first string and returns the combined string.
Let's take a look at the following example:

```
<?php

$str = 'This is ' . ' the string #' . 1;
;echo $str
```

2.3 FLOW-CONTROL STATEMENTS

PHP supports a number of traditional programming constructs for controlling the flow of execution of a program.

Conditional statements, such as if/else and switch, allow a program to execute different pieces of code, or none at all, depending on some condition. Loops, such as while and for, support the repeated execution of particular code.

2.3.1 PHP if Statement

The if statement has the following general form: